ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT ASSESSMENT AND NGT

PRIOR-CLEARANCE FIREWALL → APPROVAL MATRIX → CLASSIFICATION GATE → FOUR-PROCESS DISTINCTION → EIA EVIDENCE CHAIN → CONSULTATION QUALITY GATE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

PRIOR-CLEARANCE FIREWALL

PRIOR-CLEARANCE FIREWALL | PROJECT CONCEPT | TEST EIA SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY | PRIOR EC REQUIRED | APPRAISAL BEFORE PROHIBITED START | CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION | COMPETENT AUTHORITY DECISION | CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION

PROJECT CONCEPT → test EIA schedule applicability → PRIOR EC REQUIRED → appraisal before prohibited start → CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION → competent authority decision → CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION → only under applicable approvals → RULE → later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal

SYSTEM INPUT / STARTING CONDITION

- PROJECT CONCEPT → test EIA schedule applicability
- PRIOR EC REQUIRED → appraisal before prohibited start

ECOLOGICAL PROCESS / TRANSFER

- CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION → competent authority decision
- CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION → only under applicable approvals

OUTCOME / FEEDBACK / LIMIT

- RULE → later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal
- PROJECT CONCEPT → test EIA schedule applicability

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal.

01

STAGE 01

APPROVAL MATRIX

APPROVAL MATRIX | ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE | PROJECT IMPACT APPRAISAL | CTE OR CTO | POLLUTION-CONTROL CONSENT | FOREST CLEARANCE | FOREST-LAW DECISION | WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal	FOREST CLEARANCE → forest-law decision	NO SUBSTITUTION → each approval retains its own test
CTE OR CTO → pollution-control consent	WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL → separate legal interest	ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER

- ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal
- CTE OR CTO → pollution-control consent

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- FOREST CLEARANCE → forest-law decision
- WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL → separate legal interest

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION

- NO SUBSTITUTION → each approval retains its own test
- ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE → project impact appraisal

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO SUBSTITUTION → each approval retains its own test.

02

STAGE 02

CLASSIFICATION GATE

CLASSIFICATION GATE | PROJECT OR ACTIVITY | READ CURRENT SCHEDULE | THRESHOLD AND LOCATION | APPLY NOTIFIED CRITERIA | CATEGORY A OR B | COMPETENT APPRAISAL LEVEL | B1 OR B2

PROJECT OR ACTIVITY → read current schedule

THRESHOLD AND LOCATION → apply notified criteria → CATEGORY A OR B → competent appraisal level → B1 OR B2 → assessment route only where supported

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION

- PROJECT OR ACTIVITY → read current schedule
- THRESHOLD AND LOCATION → apply notified criteria

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM

- CATEGORY A OR B → competent appraisal level
- B1 OR B2 → assessment route only where supported

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT

- NO GUESS → title or size alone is insufficient
- PROJECT OR ACTIVITY → read current schedule

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO GUESS → title or size alone is insufficient.

03

STAGE 03

FOUR-PROCESS DISTINCTION

FOUR-PROCESS DISTINCTION | DETERMINE APPLICABLE ROUTE WHERE REQUIRED | SET SIGNIFICANT ISSUES AND TERMS OF REFERENCE | PUBLIC CONSULTATION | RECEIVE AFFECTED AND STAKEHOLDER CONCERNS | EXPERT REVIEW OF THE FULL RECORD | COMPETENT AUTHORITY GRANTS, CONDITIONS OR REJECTS

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
SCREENING → determine applicable route where required	PUBLIC CONSULTATION → receive affected and stakeholder concerns	DECISION → competent authority grants, conditions or rejects
SCOPING → set significant issues and terms of reference	APPRAISAL → expert review of the full record	SCREENING → determine applicable route where required

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER

- SCREENING → determine applicable route where required
- SCOPING → set significant issues and terms of reference

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- PUBLIC CONSULTATION → receive affected and stakeholder concerns
- APPRAISAL → expert review of the full record

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION

- DECISION → competent authority grants, conditions or rejects
- SCREENING → determine applicable route where required

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECISION → competent authority grants, conditions or rejects.

04

STAGE 04

EIA EVIDENCE CHAIN

EIA EVIDENCE CHAIN | EXISTING ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL CONDITION | SITE, TECHNOLOGY AND NO-PROJECT COMPARISON | IMPACT PREDICTION | MAGNITUDE, DURATION AND UNCERTAINTY | AVOID, MINIMISE, RESTORE OR COMPENSATE | EMP AND MONITORING | IMPLEMENTATION AND VERIFICATION

BASELINE → existing environmental and social condition → ALTERNATIVES → site, technology and no-project comparison → IMPACT PREDICTION → magnitude, duration and uncertainty → MITIGATION → avoid, minimise, restore or compensate → EMP AND MONITORING → implementation and verification

SYSTEM INPUT / STARTING CONDITION

- BASELINE → existing environmental and social condition
- ALTERNATIVES → site, technology and no-project comparison

ECOLOGICAL PROCESS / TRANSFER

- IMPACT PREDICTION → magnitude, duration and uncertainty
- MITIGATION → avoid, minimise, restore or compensate

OUTCOME / FEEDBACK / LIMIT

- EMP AND MONITORING → implementation and verification
- BASELINE → existing environmental and social condition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MITIGATION → avoid, minimise, restore or compensate; EMP AND MONITORING → implementation and verification.

05

STAGE 05

CONSULTATION QUALITY GATE

CONSULTATION QUALITY GATE | READ CURRENT NOTIFICATION | NOTICE AND ACCESS | AFFECTED PEOPLE CAN INSPECT MATERIAL | HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE | COLLECT CONCERNS | APPRAISAL RESPONSE | SHOW HOW ISSUES WERE CONSIDERED

APPLICABILITY → read current notification → NOTICE AND ACCESS → affected people can inspect material → HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE → collect concerns → APPRAISAL RESPONSE → show how issues were considered → EXEMPTION CLAIM → cite exact provision or do not assert it

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION

- APPLICABILITY → read current notification
- NOTICE AND ACCESS → affected people can inspect material

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM

- HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE → collect concerns
- APPRAISAL RESPONSE → show how issues were considered

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT

- EXEMPTION CLAIM → cite exact provision or do not assert it
- APPLICABILITY → read current notification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXEMPTION CLAIM → cite exact provision or do not assert it.

06

STAGE 06

RECOMMENDATION-DECISION LADDER

RECOMMENDATION-DECISION LADDER | PROJECT RECORD | EIA, EMP AND CONSULTATION MATERIAL | EXPERT COMMITTEE | APPRAISAL AND RECOMMENDATION | COMPETENT AUTHORITY | FINAL REASONED ORDER | ENFORCEABLE PROJECT OBLIGATIONS

PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material

EXPERT COMMITTEE → appraisal and recommendation → COMPETENT AUTHORITY → final reasoned order → CONDITIONS → enforceable project obligations

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION

- PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material
- EXPERT COMMITTEE → appraisal and recommendation

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM

- COMPETENT AUTHORITY → final reasoned order
- CONDITIONS → enforceable project obligations

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT

- MONITORING → evidence after grant
- PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROJECT RECORD → EIA, EMP and consultation material.

07

STAGE 07

GRANT-TO-OUTCOME CHAIN

GRANT-TO-OUTCOME CHAIN | CLEARANCE GRANTED | LEGAL DECISION | CONDITION LISTED | REQUIRED SAFEGUARD | ACTION IMPLEMENTED | PHYSICAL COMPLIANCE | MONITORING VERIFIED

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION

- CLEARANCE GRANTED → legal decision
- CONDITION LISTED → required safeguard

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM

- ACTION IMPLEMENTED → physical compliance
- MONITORING VERIFIED → evidence stage

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT

- OUTCOME → environmental result, separately assessed
- CLEARANCE GRANTED → legal decision

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MONITORING VERIFIED → evidence stage; OUTCOME → environmental result, separately assessed.

08

STAGE 08

NGT IDENTITY MAP

NGT IDENTITY MAP | SPECIALISED STATUTORY TRIBUNAL | CPCB OR SPCB | POLLUTION-CONTROL REGULATOR | EAC OR SEAC | APPRAISAL COMMITTEE | CLEARANCE AUTHORITY | ADMINISTRATIVE DECISION-MAKER

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
NGT → specialised statutory tribunal	EAC OR SEAC → appraisal committee	CONSTITUTIONAL COURT → writ and appellate constitutional role
CPCB OR SPCB → pollution-control regulator	CLEARANCE AUTHORITY → administrative decision-maker	NGT → specialised statutory tribunal

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER

- NGT → specialised statutory tribunal
- CPCB OR SPCB → pollution-control regulator

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- EAC OR SEAC → appraisal committee
- CLEARANCE AUTHORITY → administrative decision-maker

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION

- CONSTITUTIONAL COURT → writ and appellate constitutional role
- NGT → specialised statutory tribunal

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSTITUTIONAL COURT → writ and appellate constitutional role.

09

STAGE 09

JURISDICTION FORK

JURISDICTION FORK | SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION | TEST SCHEDULE I BOUNDARY | ORIGINAL CASE | CIVIL ENVIRONMENTAL DISPUTE UNDER THE ACT | SPECIFIED ORDER AND APPEAL PROVISION | WRIT ROUTE | SEPARATE CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW

SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION → test Schedule I boundary

ORIGINAL CASE → civil environmental dispute under the Act → APPEAL → specified order and appeal provision → WRIT ROUTE → separate constitutional review

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION

- SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION → test Schedule I boundary
- ORIGINAL CASE → civil environmental dispute under the Act

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM

- APPEAL → specified order and appeal provision
- WRIT ROUTE → separate constitutional review

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT

- NO LABEL-BASED JURISDICTION → statute controls
- SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION → test Schedule I boundary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ORIGINAL CASE → civil environmental dispute under the Act.

10

STAGE 10

REMEDY AND LIMITATION MATRIX

REMEDY AND LIMITATION MATRIX | RELIEF OR COMPENSATION | PERSON OR DAMAGE CLAIM | PROPERTY RESTITUTION | RESTORE AFFECTED PROPERTY | ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION | REPAIR ENVIRONMENTAL HARM | REMEDY-SPECIFIC CLOCK AND EXTENSION

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim	ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION → repair environmental harm	PRINCIPLES → apply within jurisdiction and evidence
PROPERTY RESTITUTION → restore affected property	LIMITATION → remedy-specific clock and extension	RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER

- RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim
- PROPERTY RESTITUTION → restore affected property

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION → repair environmental harm
- LIMITATION → remedy-specific clock and extension

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION

- PRINCIPLES → apply within jurisdiction and evidence
- RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RELIEF OR COMPENSATION → person or damage claim.

11

STAGE 11

INSTRUMENT AND ANSWER SPINE

INSTRUMENT AND ANSWER SPINE | APPLICABILITY, CATEGORY, STUDY AND CONSULTATION | APPRAISAL, REASONED ORDER AND DISTINCT APPROVALS | CONDITIONS, COMPLIANCE AND ENVIRONMENTAL OUTCOME | NGT JURISDICTION, APPEAL, RELIEF AND LIMITATION | DRAFT, NOTIFICATION, MEMORANDUM, JUDGMENT AND PYQ STATUS

PREVENT → applicability, category, study and consultation → DECIDE → appraisal, reasoned order and distinct approvals → MONITOR → conditions, compliance and environmental outcome → REMEDY → NGT jurisdiction, appeal, relief and limitation → AUDIT → draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION

- PREVENT → applicability, category, study and consultation
- DECIDE → appraisal, reasoned order and distinct approvals

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM

- MONITOR → conditions, compliance and environmental outcome
- REMEDY → NGT jurisdiction, appeal, relief and limitation

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT

- AUDIT → draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status
- PREVENT → applicability, category, study and consultation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AUDIT → draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | PERIODIC PROPOSALS TO STREAMLINE OR REVISE THE EIA PROCESS | BALANCED FRAMING FOR MAINS | PRESENT THIS AS A GENUINE TRADE-OFF REQUIRING CAREFUL | COMPREHENSIVE, INDEPENDENTLY COMPILED NATIONAL DATA ON EIA CLEARANCE APPROVAL/ | NGT CASE-DISPOSAL STATISTICS (PENDENCY, AVERAGE DISPOSAL TIME) ARE REPORTED | POST-FACTO (RETROSPECTIVE) ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE HAS BEEN TREATED BY INDIAN | NGT'S ORIGINAL JURISDICTION COVERS SUBSTANTIAL QUESTIONS RELATING TO ENVIRONMENT

OPTIONAL ECOLOGICAL PROCESS DEPTH

- CAUTION: Periodic proposals to streamline or revise the EIA process (e.g., reducing timelines,
- CAUTION: Balanced framing for Mains: present this as a genuine trade-off requiring careful
- CAUTION: Comprehensive, independently compiled national data on EIA clearance approval/
- CAUTION: NGT case-disposal statistics (pendency, average disposal time) are reported

SCALE, PARAMETER OR STATUS LIMIT

- Post-facto (retrospective) environmental clearance has been treated by Indian courts and
- NGT's original jurisdiction covers substantial questions relating to environment arising
- Public consultation under the EIA process has faced documented implementation critiques
- NGT order implementation ultimately depends on executive/state-agency compliance

COMPARATIVE RESTORATION NUANCE

- NOT: Post-facto environmental clearance has been judicially endorsed as a routine, regular
- NOT: NGT has unlimited jurisdiction over every environment-related legal matter in India.
- NOT: Public-consultation critiques primarily concern the absence of any consultation
- NOT: NGT orders are self-executing and require no further executive action. - Implementation

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels